

IELTS Evidence Guide & Assessment Rubric

Compact Student + Teacher Reference

Academic + General Training | Four skills | Bands 0-9

Evidence checked 6 September 2026 | Complete revamp

Every scoring rule and band row is cited. Every Writing and Speaking band row pairs observable evidence with a next preparation target. Full source URLs remain visible and copyable if a PDF viewer blocks clicking.

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Students: use Sections 1-6. Teachers: diagnose with the skill section, record evidence in Section 7, and use Section 8 only when the rating needs review.

Start here

Purpose. Find the evidence behind the current result, identify the exact feature blocking the next band, practise that feature, and confirm the change in a comparable task. This is an independent classroom resource; IELTS alone issues official results. [I-SCORE](#) [R-FEEDBACK](#)

Two routes

Reader	Fast route	Full route
Student	Record the current result in Section 1, open the tested skill, compare the current evidence with the next target, and complete Section 6. R-RUBRIC	Read Sections 1-6 for the complete four-skill preparation system. I-SCORE
Teacher	Rate the complete sample, identify the first unsupported next-band feature, prescribe its matching practice action, and record the recheck in Section 7. I-WRITE I-SPEAK	Use Section 8 only for rating gates, moderation, access, and reporting limits. T-STAND

Five actions

Step	Action
1	Record the current score or criterion profile under the actual test conditions. T-STAND
2	Locate the repeated answer failure or the first next-band descriptor clause the sample does not yet support. I-WRITE I-SPEAK
3	Quote or mark the exact response evidence; one isolated error does not establish a pattern. R-READ
4	Complete the matching practice action from the skill section. R-FEEDBACK
5	Recheck the named feature in a fresh comparable task and retain it only when the success condition is met. R-RUBRIC

1. Score system

1.1 What produces each score

Skill	Evidence	Scoring rule
Listening	40 keyed questions across four recordings. I-LISTEN	One mark per correct answer; the raw mark is converted to a band, with exact boundaries varying slightly by test version. I-SCORE
Reading	40 keyed questions in 60 minutes; Academic and General Training use different texts. I-READ-A I-READ-G	One mark per correct answer; Academic and General Training use separate conversions, and exact boundaries vary slightly by form. I-SCORE
Writing	Task 1 and Task 2, each rated on four criteria; Task 2 carries twice the weight of Task 1. I-WRITE-A I-WRITE-G	Rate each task against Task Achievement/Response, Coherence and Cohesion, Lexical Resource, and Grammatical Range and Accuracy. I-WRITE
Speaking	Average performance across one complete three-part interview. I-SPEAK	Fluency and Coherence, Lexical Resource, Grammatical Range and Accuracy, and Pronunciation contribute equally. I-SCORE

1.2 Overall result

Overall = (Listening + Reading + Writing + Speaking) / 4. IELTS reports the nearest whole or half band: an average ending in .25 rounds to the next half band, and .75 rounds to the next whole band; for example, **6.25** -> **6.5**, **6.75** -> **7.0**, and **6.125** -> **6.0**. Apply this only to four official component scores belonging to the same authorised result. [I-SCORE](#)

1.3 Higher-band target planner

Use the overall formula only after setting a component target. Listening and Reading improvement is tracked through raw marks and repeated item failures; Writing and Speaking improvement is tracked criterion by criterion. [I-SCORE](#) [R-READ](#)

Component	Current evidence	Next target	Blocking feature and recheck
Listening	_____	_____	_____ I-LISTEN
Reading	_____	_____	_____ R-READ
Writing	_____	_____	_____ I-WRITE
Speaking	_____	_____	_____ I-SPEAK

1.4 Rating rule

- Listening and Reading are keyed tests. Mark answers; do not invent qualitative band descriptors. [I-SCORE](#)
- Writing and Speaking are criterion-rated. Rate every criterion separately from the complete sample. [I-WRITE](#) [I-SPEAK](#)
- For a productive-skill criterion, select the whole-band descriptor whose positive features are fully supported, then check the band above and below and apply any limiting condition printed in the official descriptor. [I-WRITE](#) [I-SPEAK](#)
- Descriptor clauses are evidence features, not points. Strength in one criterion cannot erase weakness in another. [I-WRITE](#) [T-STAND](#)
- Use whole bands for classroom criterion ratings because the public analytic descriptors provide whole-band anchors; do not invent half-band descriptors. [I-WRITE](#) [I-SPEAK](#)
- Treat one practice result as one performance. Confirm progress with comparable tasks completed under recorded conditions. [T-STAND](#)

2. Listening

2.1 Official structure and marking

Point	Rule
Test	Academic and General Training use the same Listening test: four parts, 10 questions per part, and 40 questions in total. I-LISTEN
Recording	Each recording is heard once; questions follow the order of information in the recording. I-LISTEN
Context	Parts 1-2 use everyday social contexts; Parts 3-4 use education, training, or academic contexts. I-LISTEN
Voices	Recordings may include British, Australian, New Zealand, North American, and other English accents. I-LISTEN
Mark	Each correct answer receives one mark; use the authorised key and the exact question instructions. I-SCORE
Completion	A response must obey the stated word/number limit; spelling and grammar can affect whether a completion answer is accepted. I-LISTEN

2.2 Published raw-score anchors

IELTS publishes these as average marks; the precise mark required varies slightly across test versions. Use a form-specific conversion whenever the practice material provides one. [I-SCORE](#)

Band	Average correct answers /40
8	35. I-SCORE
7	30. I-SCORE
6	23. I-SCORE
5	16. I-SCORE

2.3 Answer gate

Check	Mark the answer correct only when...
Key	It matches an accepted key answer or authorised variant. I-LISTEN-SAMPLE
Count	It supplies exactly the requested number of answers or selections. I-LISTEN
Limit	It stays within the printed word/number limit. I-LISTEN
Form	It fits the surrounding note, form, sentence, table, summary, or flow chart grammatically when the task requires completion. I-LISTEN
Spelling	The written form is accepted by the key; standard British and American spelling are accepted. I-LISTEN
Extras	It contains no extra selection or word that makes the response invalid under that item instruction. I-LISTEN-SAMPLE

2.4 Question-type improvement checks

A wrong answer identifies a missed item. Teach a cause only after the same failure repeats or a transcript-supported recheck confirms it. [T-STAND](#)

Item or repeat failure	Exact practice action	Success evidence
Multiple choice selects an early distractor	Mark every correction, contrast, changed number, and final decision before choosing. I-LISTEN-SAMPLE	The final choice matches the speaker's completed position across two new sets. R-FEEDBACK
Matching confuses speakers, options, or viewpoints	Keep a speaker-option log and mark agreement, disagreement, and revision. I-LISTEN	Each selected option can be tied to the correct speaker and proposition. R-FEEDBACK
Plan, map, or diagram labels are wrong	Fix the starting point, then trace direction, relative position, landmark, and destination. I-LISTEN	A new route is labelled without losing orientation after a turn. R-FEEDBACK
Form, note, table, flow-chart, or summary completion loses marks	Predict noun, verb, adjective, number, or name before listening; apply the answer gate afterward. I-LISTEN	Content, grammar, spelling, and word limit all satisfy the key in two new sets. I-LISTEN-SAMPLE
Sentence completion misses the keyed paraphrase	Pair the question phrase with the recording's exact paraphrase, then retry without transcript support. I-LISTEN	The answer is located from meaning rather than repeated wording. R-FEEDBACK
Short answers violate count or word limits	Box the number of required answers and the maximum permitted words before listening. I-LISTEN	Every correct idea is submitted in an accepted form. I-LISTEN-SAMPLE
One miss produces several blanks	Leave the missed item immediately and relocate using the next stem's distinctive words. I-LISTEN	A missed item no longer causes a second consecutive blank. R-FEEDBACK
Part 4 detail collapses	Record lecture hierarchy through topic, sequence, contrast, cause, and result before adding detail. I-LISTEN	Notes preserve the main structure and supply the keyed details in a fresh lecture. R-FEEDBACK

3. Reading

3.1 Official structure

Feature	Academic Reading	General Training Reading
Time and questions	60 minutes including answer entry; 40 questions. I-READ-A	60 minutes including answer entry; 40 questions. I-READ-G
Organisation	Three long texts totalling about 2,150-2,750 words. I-READ-A	Three sections of increasing difficulty, using several texts totalling about 2,150-2,375 words. I-READ-G
Sources	Books, journals, magazines, newspapers, and online resources written for a non-specialist audience. I-READ-A	Everyday notices/materials, workplace texts, and one longer general-interest text. I-READ-G
Conversion	Academic form conversion. I-SCORE	General Training form conversion; it generally requires more correct answers for a given band. I-SCORE

3.2 Published raw-score anchors

These are IELTS's published average marks; exact boundaries vary slightly by test version. Use the conversion supplied with the exact practice form. [I-SCORE](#)

Band	Academic average /40	General Training average /40
8	35. I-SCORE	IELTS does not publish an average at this band on the cited scoring page. I-SCORE
7	30. I-SCORE	35. I-SCORE
6	23. I-SCORE	30. I-SCORE
5	15. I-SCORE	23. I-SCORE
4	IELTS does not publish an average at this band on the cited scoring page. I-SCORE	15. I-SCORE

3.3 Answer decisions

Item	Correct decision
True / False / Not Given	True: agrees with text information. False: contradicts text information. Not Given: the text neither confirms nor contradicts it. I-READ-A
Yes / No / Not Given	Yes: agrees with the writer's view or claim. No: contradicts that view or claim. Not Given: the view or claim is neither stated nor contradicted. I-READ-A
Completion	Use words from the text when instructed, stay within the word/number limit, and make the completed sentence or note grammatically fit. I-READ-A I-READ-G
Matching	Use each option only as permitted by the instructions; some tasks permit reuse and others do not. I-READ-A
Evidence	Decide from the text; outside knowledge cannot supply missing textual evidence. I-READ-A

3.4 Question-type improvement checks

These error categories guide follow-up practice; they are not official subscores and do not prove an unseen cognitive cause. [R-READ](#)

Item or repeat failure	Exact practice action	Success evidence
Multiple choice finds the area but accepts a distractor	Compare qualifier, negation, comparison, time, group, and degree in every option. I-READ-A	The chosen option matches every limiting word in the text across two new sets. R-FEEDBACK
True/False or Yes/No is chosen when evidence is absent	Require a confirming or contradicting line; use Not Given when neither exists. I-READ-A	Every True/Yes or False/No answer has a proof line; every Not Given answer lacks one. R-FEEDBACK
Matching information cannot locate a detail	Predict two paraphrases and scan for distinctive names, dates, terms, or relationships. I-READ-A	The paragraph is found through paraphrase and verified in its complete sentence. R-FEEDBACK
Matching headings follows examples instead of the main idea	Write a five-to-eight-word paragraph gist before viewing the headings. I-READ-A	The chosen heading covers the paragraph as a whole and excludes detail-only distractors. R-FEEDBACK
Matching features confuses people, theories, or categories	Build a compact entity-to-claim ledger and check whether options may repeat. I-READ-A	Each match is supported by the named entity's exact claim or feature. R-FEEDBACK
Matching sentence endings produces a grammatical but false sentence	Read the complete joined sentence and verify meaning, grammar, and textual support. I-READ-A	Every ending satisfies all three checks in a fresh set. R-FEEDBACK

Item or repeat failure	Exact practice action	Success evidence
Sentence, summary, note, table, or flow-chart completion is rejected	Predict part of speech, copy only the permitted text span, and apply limit, spelling, and grammar checks. I-READ-A	The answer matches the key without boundary or form errors in two new sets. R-FEEDBACK
Diagram labels confuse process or location	Trace the described sequence or spatial relation and pair each blank with its anchor. I-READ-A	Every label is supported by the correct process stage or location phrase. R-FEEDBACK
Short answers exceed the permitted form	Box the requested number of answers and word limit, then copy the smallest complete answer. I-READ-A	Each answer is complete, text-supported, and within the printed limit. R-FEEDBACK
Final passage or section is unfinished	Set passage checkpoints and leave one unresolved item before it consumes the next section's time. I-READ-A	All three passages receive planned time and every item receives an answer. R-FEEDBACK

4. Writing

4.1 Tasks and scoring architecture

Task	Required response	Minimum	Suggested time	Weight
Academic Task 1	Select, summarise, and compare the main features of one or more graphs, charts, tables, diagrams, processes, or maps. I-WRITE-A	150 words. I-WRITE-A	About 20 minutes. I-GUIDE	Task 1 carries one-third of the Writing task weight. I-WRITE-A
General Training Task 1	Write a personal, semi-formal, or formal letter that covers the stated situation and all three bullet requirements. I-WRITE-G	150 words. I-WRITE-G	About 20 minutes. I-GUIDE	Task 1 carries one-third of the Writing task weight. I-WRITE-G
Task 2, both tests	Write an essay that answers the exact question, develops a position, and supports main ideas. I-WRITE-A I-WRITE-G	250 words. I-WRITE-A	About 40 minutes. I-GUIDE	Task 2 carries two-thirds of the Writing task weight. I-WRITE-A

4.2 The four criteria

Criterion	Evidence to judge
Task Achievement - Academic Task 1	Accurate selection of key features, a clear overview, relevant comparisons, sufficient supporting detail, and an appropriate factual report. I-WRITE-KEY
Task Achievement - General Training Task 1	Clear purpose, coverage and extension of all bullet points, suitable tone for recipient and purpose, and appropriate letter format. I-WRITE-KEY
Task Response - Task 2	Coverage of every prompt part, a clear developed position, relevant main ideas, and explanation, reasons, evidence, or examples that support them. I-WRITE-KEY
Coherence and Cohesion	Logical progression, paragraph focus, sequencing, clear relationships, controlled linking, and effective reference and substitution. I-WRITE-KEY
Lexical Resource	Range, precision, appropriacy, register, collocation, word formation, spelling, and the frequency and effect of lexical errors. I-WRITE-KEY
Grammatical Range and Accuracy	Useful variety of simple and complex structures, accuracy, distribution of error-free sentences, punctuation, and the frequency and effect of errors. I-WRITE-KEY

4.3 Task-completion checks

Run the relevant check before language editing. A polished response cannot recover task marks lost through missing requirements, an unclear position, or an absent overview. [I-WRITE-KEY](#)

Task	Before writing	Before submitting
Academic Task 1	Identify the units, time frame, categories, two or three main patterns, and the comparisons needed to prove them. I-WRITE-A	Confirm a clear overview, selective accurate data, relevant comparisons, 150 or more words, and no unsupported explanation. I-WRITE-KEY
General Training Task 1	Identify the recipient, purpose, required tone, and the function of each bullet point. I-WRITE-G	Confirm that every bullet is developed, the purpose stays clear, tone and format fit, and the response has 150 or more words. I-WRITE-KEY
Task 2	Underline every instruction, state one answerable position, and assign one relevant main idea to each body paragraph. I-WRITE-A	Confirm that every prompt part is answered, the position remains consistent, each main idea is explained and supported, and the response has 250 or more words. I-WRITE-KEY

4.4 Academic Task 1 - Task Achievement

Band	Observable evidence	Next preparation target
9	Selective, accurate coverage fully satisfies the task; key patterns, comparisons, and support are complete; lapses are extremely rare. WBD T1 p.1	Confirm the same control across unfamiliar charts, processes, and maps under timed conditions. R-FEEDBACK
8	All requirements are covered relevantly and sufficiently; key features are skilfully selected and illustrated; lapses are occasional. WBD T1 p.1	Use a final evidence check to remove the remaining omission, inaccuracy, or unsupported comparison. I-WRITE-KEY
7	Format is appropriate; information is relevant and mainly accurate; the overview is clear; selected features need minor extension or support. WBD T1 p.1	Add only the data or comparison needed to make every selected feature precise and sufficient. I-WRITE-KEY
6	Key features and a relevant overview are attempted; support may be missing, inaccurate, irrelevant, excessive, or insufficient. WBD T1 p.2	Write the overview first, then attach accurate selective evidence to each stated pattern. I-WRITE-KEY
5	Feature selection is inadequate, detail is mechanical, the overview may be absent, and important content may be irrelevant or inaccurate. WBD T1 p.2	Identify two or three main patterns before writing and delete detail that proves none of them. I-WRITE-KEY

Band	Observable evidence	Next preparation target
4	Few key features are selected; format may be unsuitable; content may be irrelevant, repetitive, inaccurate, or inappropriate. WBD T1 p.3	Decode units, categories, and time frame, then group only accurate features into a factual report. I-WRITE-A
3	Requirements are not addressed; the visual may be misunderstood; information is slight, irrelevant, or undeveloped. WBD T1 p.3	State the visual's subject and identify at least two correct features before adding detail. I-WRITE-A
2	Content barely relates to the task. WBD T1 p.3	Produce connected factual sentences that name visible categories, values, stages, or changes. I-WRITE-A
1	The response has 20 words or fewer or wholly unrelated content; copied wording is ignored. WBD T1 p.3	Write more than 20 independent English words that describe the supplied visual directly. I-WRITE
0	The test was not attempted, was non-English throughout, or was proven wholly memorised. WBD T1 p.3	Attempt the task independently in English and produce rateable task-related language. I-WRITE

4.5 General Training Task 1 - Task Achievement

Band	Observable evidence	Next preparation target
9	Purpose, requested functions, tone, and format are fully and appropriately satisfied; lapses are extremely rare. WBD T1 p.1	Confirm the same control across personal, semi-formal, and formal situations under timed conditions. R-FEEDBACK
8	Every requirement is covered appropriately, relevantly, and sufficiently; all bullets are clearly supported; lapses are occasional. WBD T1 p.1	Remove the remaining lapse by checking each sentence against recipient, purpose, and required function. I-WRITE-KEY
7	Every bullet and function is clear; purpose, tone, and format are consistent; some development may need greater fullness or suitability. WBD T1 p.1	Add the exact explanation, request, apology, recommendation, or detail that makes each bullet sufficient. I-WRITE-KEY
6	All bullets are adequately covered and purpose is generally clear; tone may vary and detail may be missing, inaccurate, irrelevant, excessive, or underdeveloped. WBD T1 p.2	Give each bullet one clear function and enough recipient-appropriate detail to complete it. I-WRITE-KEY

Band	Observable evidence	Next preparation target
5	All bullets appear, though one or more are inadequate; purpose may blur; tone or format may lapse; development is limited. WBD T1 p.2	Plan recipient, purpose, tone, and one developed response for every bullet before drafting. I-WRITE-G
4	At least one bullet is omitted or purpose is confused; tone, format, or functional content may be unsuitable. WBD T1 p.3	Rewrite the task as a four-part checklist covering purpose and all three bullets. I-WRITE-G
3	Requirements are not addressed, the situation may be misunderstood, and little relevant functional content is supplied. WBD T1 p.3	Name the recipient and purpose, then write one relevant sentence for each bullet. I-WRITE-G
2	Content barely relates to the situation. WBD T1 p.3	Produce connected English sentences that address the stated situation and recipient. I-WRITE-G
1	The response has 20 words or fewer or wholly unrelated content; copied wording is ignored. WBD T1 p.3	Write more than 20 independent English words that address the letter situation directly. I-WRITE
0	The test was not attempted, was non-English throughout, or was proven wholly memorised. WBD T1 p.3	Attempt the task independently in English and produce rateable task-related language. I-WRITE

4.6 Task 2 - Task Response

Band	Observable evidence	Next preparation target
9	The prompt is answered directly and explored in depth; a fully developed position and fully supported ideas are sustained; lapses are extremely rare. WBD T2 p.1	Confirm the same depth and precision across unfamiliar prompt structures under timed conditions. R-FEEDBACK
8	The prompt is addressed appropriately and sufficiently; the position is clear and well developed; relevant ideas are extended and supported; lapses are occasional. WBD T2 p.1	Locate the remaining omission or imprecise support and revise only the paragraph responsible. I-WRITE-KEY
7	Main prompt parts are addressed; a clear developed position is sustained; support may occasionally overgeneralise or lose focus or precision. WBD T2 p.1	Replace each broad claim with an explanation and example that prove the exact paragraph claim. I-WRITE-KEY

Band	Observable evidence	Next preparation target
6	Main parts are addressed unevenly; the position is relevant; conclusions or support may be unclear, repetitive, inadequate, or less relevant. WBD T2 p.2	Give every prompt part proportionate coverage and extend each main idea through reason, consequence, or example. I-WRITE-KEY
5	Main parts are incomplete; the position is inconsistently clear; ideas are limited or underdeveloped and include irrelevant detail or repetition. WBD T2 p.2	Write one direct position and one relevant, explained main idea for every required prompt part. I-WRITE-A
4	The prompt is handled minimally, partly, indirectly, or through misunderstanding; position and support are difficult to identify. WBD T2 p.3	Paraphrase each instruction as a question, answer each directly, and remove unrelated material. I-WRITE-A
3	No prompt part is adequately answered; no relevant position is identifiable; only a few undeveloped or irrelevant ideas appear. WBD T2 p.3	State one relevant answer and develop it through one reason and one concrete example. I-WRITE-A
2	Content barely relates to the prompt; no position is identifiable; only one or two undeveloped fragments appear. WBD T2 p.3	Produce connected sentences that answer the prompt and express one identifiable position. I-WRITE-A
1	The response has 20 words or fewer or wholly unrelated content; copied wording is ignored. WBD T2 p.3	Write more than 20 independent English words that answer the prompt directly. I-WRITE
0	The test was not attempted, was non-English throughout, or was proven wholly memorised. WBD T2 p.3	Attempt the task independently in English and produce rateable task-related language. I-WRITE

4.7 Coherence and Cohesion - both tasks

Band	Observable evidence	Next preparation target
9	The message is effortless to follow; cohesion rarely attracts attention; paragraphing is skilful; lapses are minimal. WBD T1/T2 p.1	Confirm unobtrusive cohesion and exact paragraph functions across new timed tasks. R-CC
8	The message is easy to follow; sequencing, cohesion, and paragraphing are well controlled; lapses are occasional. WBD T1/T2 p.1	Remove the remaining progression or reference lapse without adding conspicuous connectors. R-CC
7	Organisation and progression are clear with minor lapses; cohesive devices, reference, and substitution are flexible though occasionally inaccurate, excessive, or insufficient. WBD T1/T2 p.1	Give every paragraph one controlling function and repair the exact relationship or reference that remains unclear. I-WRITE-KEY
6	Overall progression is clear; cohesion can be mechanical or faulty; reference may repeat or blur; paragraph focus or logic may lapse. WBD T1/T2 p.2	Reorder ideas by function, then use a connector or reference only where the relationship requires one. R-CC
5	Organisation is visible but incompletely logical; progression and sentence links are weak; devices or paragraphing may be limited, excessive, inaccurate, or absent. WBD T1/T2 p.2	Group each main idea with its explanation and support, then order the groups into a visible argument or report. I-WRITE-KEY
4	Ideas lack coherent arrangement and clear progression; relationships are unclear; basic devices repeat or fail; paragraph focus may be absent. WBD T1/T2 p.3	Sort sentences into beginning, main points, support, and ending before rewriting links. I-WRITE-KEY
3	No logical organisation is apparent; ideas are difficult to connect; sequencers and paragraph attempts do not establish relationships. WBD T1/T2 p.3	Build one four-sentence unit with a main point, explanation, example, and consequence. R-FEEDBACK
2	Little relevant message or control of organisation is evident. WBD T1/T2 p.3	Join related sentences into one understandable sequence about the task. I-WRITE
1	A response of 20 words or fewer supplies no usable cohesion or communicated message. WBD T1/T2 p.3	Produce enough connected task language to establish one complete message. I-WRITE
0	The global Band 0 task condition applies. WBD T1/T2 p.3	Attempt the task independently in English so organisation can be rated. I-WRITE

4.8 Lexical Resource - both tasks

Band	Observable evidence	Next preparation target
9	Vocabulary is fully flexible, precise, accurate, appropriate, and natural; sophisticated control is sustained; slips are extremely rare. WBD T1/T2 p.1	Confirm the same precision and natural collocation across unfamiliar topics and tasks. R-WRITE
8	A wide resource conveys precise meaning flexibly; less-common or idiomatic language is skilful; occasional errors have minimal effect. WBD T1/T2 p.1	Replace the remaining imprecise choice and verify collocation, register, spelling, and formation in context. I-WRITE-KEY
7	Range supports flexibility and precision; style and collocation awareness appear; occasional unsuitable choices or spelling and formation errors preserve clarity. WBD T1/T2 p.1	Build precise topic-neutral paraphrases and collocations, then use them naturally in a new response. I-WRITE-KEY
6	Vocabulary is generally adequate and appropriate; range or precision is restricted; risk-taking may increase inaccuracy; errors do not obstruct communication. WBD T1/T2 p.2	Replace repeated general words with exact task meanings and check every new collocation before retaining it. I-WRITE-KEY
5	Resource is limited but sufficient for basic meaning; variation is weak; unsuitable choices, repetition, spelling, or formation errors recur and may strain the reader. WBD T1/T2 p.2	Build accurate word families and collocations for the ideas already used, then rewrite without forced synonyms. R-WRITE
4	Resource is limited, inadequate, or partly unrelated; basic words repeat; formulaic chunks and frequent errors can impede meaning. WBD T1/T2 p.3	Learn and accurately reuse the core nouns, verbs, modifiers, and collocations needed for the task's own ideas. I-WRITE-KEY
3	Resource is inadequate; prompt or memorised language dominates; word-choice or spelling errors severely block meaning. WBD T1/T2 p.3	Replace copied strings with short original sentences using a controlled task-relevant word set. I-WRITE
2	Only a few recognisable, largely memorised strings appear; word formation and spelling show no control. WBD T1/T2 p.3	Produce original subject-verb-object sentences with correctly spelled high-frequency task words. I-WRITE
1	At 20 words or fewer, no usable lexical resource appears beyond isolated words. WBD T1/T2 p.3	Build a connected task response from a small accurate vocabulary rather than isolated words. I-WRITE
0	The global Band 0 task condition applies. WBD T1/T2 p.3	Attempt the task independently in English so lexical resource can be rated. I-WRITE

4.9 Grammatical Range and Accuracy - both tasks

Band	Observable evidence	Next preparation target
9	A wide range is fully flexible and controlled; grammar and punctuation are appropriate throughout; slips are extremely rare. WBD T1/T2 p.1	Confirm the same control when task complexity and time pressure change. R-ERROR
8	A wide range is flexible and accurate; most sentences are error-free; punctuation is well managed; occasional errors have minimal effect. WBD T1/T2 p.1	Identify the remaining non-systematic errors and reproduce those structures accurately in new task content. R-ERROR
7	Varied complex structures show flexibility and accuracy; error-free sentences are frequent; a few errors persist without impeding communication. WBD T1/T2 p.1	Track the repeated error pattern and correct it across several independently written complex sentences. R-ERROR
6	Simple and complex forms are mixed; complex forms are less accurate and flexibility is limited; errors rarely obstruct communication. WBD T1/T2 p.2	Practise the relationships the task needs through accurate cause, contrast, condition, comparison, and qualification structures. I-WRITE-KEY
5	Range is limited and repetitive; simple sentences are most accurate; complex attempts and punctuation errors may cause difficulty. WBD T1/T2 p.2	Combine accurate simple sentences into controlled compound and subordinate structures without losing meaning. R-ERROR
4	Range is very limited; simple sentences dominate; subordination is rare; frequent grammar and punctuation errors can impede meaning. WBD T1/T2 p.3	Stabilise sentence boundaries, agreement, tense, articles, and basic punctuation before extending clauses. I-WRITE-KEY
3	Sentence forms are attempted, but errors dominate outside memorised or copied phrases and prevent most meaning. WBD T1/T2 p.3	Build short original sentences with complete subjects, finite verbs, and clear boundaries. I-WRITE
2	Little or no evidence of sentence forms appears beyond memorised phrases. WBD T1/T2 p.3	Produce original complete simple sentences about the task before attempting complexity. I-WRITE
1	At 20 words or fewer, the script supplies no usable grammar evidence. WBD T1/T2 p.3	Produce enough connected original sentences for grammatical control to be assessed. I-WRITE
0	The global Band 0 task condition applies. WBD T1/T2 p.3	Attempt the task independently in English so grammar can be rated. I-WRITE

4.10 Evidence-to-action checks

Research supports using several language features together; no single complexity measure or fixed error count defines a Writing band. [R-WRITE](#) [R-ERROR](#)

Barrier found in the rated script	Action	Success evidence in the next script
Task coverage or support prevents the next TA/TR band	Rewrite the weakest paragraph or missing requirement with relevant explanation, data, comparison, reason, or example. I-WRITE-KEY	The added material answers the exact requirement and removes the recorded TA/TR gap. R-FEEDBACK
Progression or paragraph focus prevents the next CC band	Reorder ideas and write one controlling function for each paragraph before revising links. R-CC	A reader can state each paragraph's role and follow the progression without relying on repeated mechanical connectors. I-WRITE
Precision, collocation, or repetition prevents the next LR band	Replace only the imprecise or repeated items identified in context and check collocation and register. I-WRITE-KEY	Revised choices express the intended meaning naturally and do not introduce new formation or spelling errors. I-WRITE
Complex-form accuracy prevents the next GRA band	Select one repeated error pattern, correct it, and produce new sentences using the same structure for genuine task content. R-ERROR	The new sample shows accurate use across several independent sentences without reducing range. I-WRITE

5. Speaking

5.1 Test and rating architecture

Part	Time	Evidence opportunity
1	4-5 minutes. I-SPEAK-FMT	Answers about home, family, work, study, interests, and other familiar topics show spontaneous everyday control. I-SPEAK-FMT
2	3-4 minutes, including one minute of preparation and a long turn of up to two minutes. I-SPEAK-FMT	The task card tests sustained development; the examiner may ask one or two brief follow-up questions. I-SPEAK-FMT
3	4-5 minutes. I-SPEAK-FMT	Discussion linked to Part 2 tests explanation, comparison, qualification, and more abstract ideas. I-SPEAK-FMT

The test lasts 11-14 minutes. Rate average performance across all three parts; each of the four criteria contributes equally. The public scoring system reports one Speaking band and no separate part bands. [I-SPEAK](#)
[I-SCORE](#)

5.2 The four criteria

Criterion	Evidence to judge
Fluency and Coherence	Continuity, pace, repetition, self-correction, idea-planning versus language-search pauses, relevance, development, logical connection, and use of cohesive devices. I-SPEAK-KEY
Lexical Resource	Breadth, precision, appropriacy, collocation, less-common or idiomatic language where natural, and ability to paraphrase around a missing word. I-SPEAK-KEY
Grammatical Range and Accuracy	Variety and flexibility of sentence forms, frequency and pattern of errors, distribution of error-free sentences, and effect on comprehension. I-SPEAK-KEY
Pronunciation	Range and control of phonological features, meaningful chunking, connected speech, rhythm, stress, intonation, word and phoneme production, intelligibility, and listener effort. I-SPEAK-KEY

5.3 Part-by-part practice checks

Practice all three parts because the final rating reflects average performance across the complete interview.

[I-SPEAK](#)

Part	Preparation action	Success evidence
1	Answer immediately, then extend with one reason, example, comparison, or consequence without reciting a prepared paragraph. I-SPEAK-FMT	Several answers remain direct, developed, natural, and independently phrased. I-SPEAK-KEY
2	Use the preparation minute to sequence three or four content points and reserve language planning for essential topic words. I-SPEAK-FMT	The long turn approaches two minutes, follows a clear sequence, and develops every card point. I-SPEAK
3	State a position, explain its cause or basis, give an example, then compare, qualify, or consider an alternative. I-SPEAK-FMT	Abstract answers remain relevant and developed while grammar, vocabulary, and pronunciation stay controlled. I-SPEAK-KEY

5.4 Fluency and Coherence

Band	Observable evidence	Next preparation target
9	Speech is fluent; repetition and repair are very occasional; hesitation plans content; cohesion and topic extension are fully controlled. SBD p.1	Confirm effortless control across unfamiliar Part 2 and Part 3 topics under test timing. R-SPEAK
8	Speech is fluent; repetition and repair are very occasional; language-search hesitation is occasional; development is coherent, relevant, and appropriate. SBD p.1	Locate the remaining language-search pause and practise retrieving that function in a fresh topic. I-SPEAK-KEY
7	Long turns are readily produced; language-access hesitation or repair occurs without damaging coherence; cohesive features are flexible. SBD p.1	Extend answers through clear idea structure while reducing mid-sentence vocabulary and grammar searches. I-SPEAK-KEY
6	Long turns are attempted; hesitation, repetition, or repair sometimes damages coherence; cohesive devices vary but may be inappropriate. SBD p.2	Plan content order before speaking and repeat the task once with fewer language-search interruptions. R-FEEDBACK

Band	Observable evidence	Next preparation target
5	Speech usually continues despite slow delivery, repetition, correction, and basic language searches; devices may be overused; complexity causes disfluency. SBD p.2	Practise one-minute answers built from answer, reason, example, and result without restarting sentences. I-SPEAK-KEY
4	Pauses prevent sustained speech; delivery is slow, repetitive, or frequently corrected; repetitive links and breakdowns occur. SBD p.2	Build short linked answers from familiar content, then extend one sentence at a time without abandoning meaning. I-SPEAK-KEY
3	Frequent long word-search pauses occur; linking and extension are limited; basic messages often fail. SBD p.3	Produce three connected sentences on familiar questions using rehearsed functions rather than memorised answers. I-SPEAK
2	A long pause precedes almost every word; isolated recognisable words carry virtually no communicative significance. SBD p.3	Practise complete high-frequency sentences for personal information and immediate needs. I-SPEAK
1	No usable fluency or coherence is evident; speech is wholly incoherent. SBD p.3	Produce one understandable complete response to a familiar question. I-SPEAK
0	The test taker does not attend or complete the test. SBD p.3	Complete a three-part practice interview so the criterion can be rated. I-SPEAK-FMT

5.5 Lexical Resource

Band	Observable evidence	Next preparation target
9	Vocabulary is completely flexible, precise, accurate, and idiomatic across contexts. SBD p.1	Confirm precise spontaneous control across unfamiliar and abstract topics. R-SPEAK
8	A wide flexible resource conveys precise meaning on all topics; less-common and idiomatic language is skilful; occasional choice or collocation errors occur; paraphrase works. SBD p.1	Correct the remaining imprecise choice or collocation and retrieve it spontaneously in a new topic. I-SPEAK-KEY
7	Vocabulary is flexible across varied topics; style and collocation awareness appear despite some unsuitable choices; paraphrase is effective. SBD p.1	Practise precise paraphrase, collocation, and topic-neutral explanation until access becomes immediate. I-SPEAK-KEY
6	Resource supports discussion at length; some choices are unsuitable; meaning remains clear; paraphrase generally succeeds. SBD p.2	Replace repeated general words through definition, contrast, function, and example without pausing the idea. I-SPEAK-KEY

Band	Observable evidence	Next preparation target
5	Resource covers familiar and unfamiliar topics with limited flexibility; paraphrase has mixed success. SBD p.2	Build accurate word families and collocations for recurring functions, then paraphrase missing words aloud. I-SPEAK-KEY
4	Resource handles familiar topics but conveys only basic meaning on unfamiliar ones; choice errors are frequent; paraphrase is rare. SBD p.2	Extend familiar-topic vocabulary and practise explaining unknown terms with simple accurate language. I-SPEAK-KEY
3	Simple vocabulary mainly handles personal information and is inadequate for unfamiliar topics. SBD p.3	Build functional sets for description, time, preference, reason, comparison, and personal experience. I-SPEAK
2	Very limited isolated words or memorised utterances appear; communication depends heavily on gesture or mime. SBD p.3	Turn high-frequency words into original complete sentences for familiar questions. I-SPEAK
1	Only a few isolated words are available and communication is impossible. SBD p.3	Learn enough accurate words to communicate one complete personal message. I-SPEAK
0	The test taker does not attend or complete the test. SBD p.3	Complete a three-part practice interview so the criterion can be rated. I-SPEAK-FMT

5.6 Grammatical Range and Accuracy

Band	Observable evidence	Next preparation target
9	Structures are precise and accurate throughout apart from slips typical of spontaneous native-speaker speech. SBD p.1	Confirm the same spontaneous control across unfamiliar topics and extended answers. R-SPEAK
8	A wide range is flexible and most sentences are error-free; occasional non-systematic or unsuitable forms and a few basic errors may remain. SBD p.1	Isolate the remaining error and reproduce the structure accurately in several spontaneous answers. I-SPEAK-KEY
7	A range is flexible and error-free sentences are frequent; simple and complex forms work despite some errors. SBD p.1	Stabilise the repeated error while retaining varied structures during unrehearsed speech. I-SPEAK-KEY
6	Short and complex forms show some variety but limited flexibility; complex-form errors are frequent and rarely obstruct communication. SBD p.2	Practise accurate cause, condition, contrast, comparison, and qualification in fresh answers. I-SPEAK-KEY

Band	Observable evidence	Next preparation target
5	Basic forms show reasonable accuracy; complex structures have limited range and errors may cause comprehension problems. SBD p.2	Extend accurate simple clauses into controlled compound and subordinate sentences. I-SPEAK-KEY
4	Basic forms and some short error-free utterances occur; subordination is rare; turns are short; structures repeat; errors are frequent. SBD p.2	Stabilise sentence boundaries, agreement, tense, and question forms before extending turns. I-SPEAK-KEY
3	Basic forms are attempted, but errors are numerous outside apparently memorised utterances. SBD p.3	Produce short original sentences with a subject, finite verb, and clear time reference. I-SPEAK
2	No evidence of basic sentence forms is present. SBD p.3	Build accurate original subject-verb-object sentences for familiar questions. I-SPEAK
1	No rateable language is present unless memorised. SBD p.3	Produce one original complete sentence that answers the question. I-SPEAK
0	The test taker does not attend or complete the test. SBD p.3	Complete a three-part practice interview so the criterion can be rated. I-SPEAK-FMT

5.7 Pronunciation

Band	Observable evidence	Next preparation target
9	A full phonological range is precise, subtle, and flexible; understanding is effortless; accent has no effect on intelligibility. SBD p.1	Confirm effortless intelligibility across unfamiliar topics, speeds, and extended answers. R-SPEAK
8	A wide range conveys precise and subtle meaning with sustained flexibility and occasional lapses; speech is easy to understand; accent has minimal effect. SBD p.1	Identify the occasional lapse and practise it inside new phrases and spontaneous answers. I-SPEAK-KEY
7	All positive Band 6 features and some positive Band 8 features are present. SBD p.1	Find the missing Band 8 feature in chunking, rhythm, stress, intonation, word, or phoneme control and practise that feature in connected speech. I-SPEAK-KEY
6	Range is present but control varies; chunking is generally appropriate; rhythm, stress, intonation, word, or phoneme lapses briefly reduce clarity; listener effort is low. SBD p.2	Record one answer, locate the feature causing each clarity loss, and repeat with corrected prominence or production. I-SPEAK-KEY

Band	Observable evidence	Next preparation target
5	All positive Band 4 features and some positive Band 6 features are present. SBD p.2	Stabilise the missing Band 6 feature across several connected phrases until listener effort falls. I-SPEAK-KEY
4	Some acceptable features and chunking occur; rhythm lapses; stress and intonation are limited; frequent word or phoneme errors reduce clarity; some stretches are unintelligible. SBD p.2	Repair the smallest repeated cause of lost meaning, then practise it in phrases rather than isolated sounds. I-SPEAK-KEY
3	Some Band 2 features and some positive Band 4 features are present. SBD p.3	Identify the Band 4 feature already emerging and stabilise it in short connected answers. I-SPEAK-KEY
2	Few acceptable features are evident; connected speech breaks down; most words and phonemes are mispronounced; speech is often unintelligible. SBD p.3	Practise intelligible high-frequency words inside short rhythmic phrases with clear word stress. I-SPEAK-KEY
1	Occasional words or phonemes are recognisable, but no overall meaning is conveyed and speech is unintelligible. SBD p.3	Make one complete familiar message intelligible to a fresh listener. I-SPEAK
0	The test taker does not attend or complete the test. SBD p.3	Complete a three-part practice interview so pronunciation can be rated. I-SPEAK-FMT

5.8 Evidence-to-action checks

Speech measures can help locate evidence, but published associations do not create fixed band thresholds.

[R-SPEAK](#)

Barrier found in the interview	Action	Success evidence in the next interview
Language-search pauses or repair prevent the next FC band	Mark where the breakdown begins, prepare idea structure and topic language separately, then repeat a comparable long turn once. I-SPEAK	Longer stretches remain coherent with fewer mid-sentence searches and no loss of relevant development. R-FEEDBACK
Imprecision or failed paraphrase prevents the next LR band	Practise explaining the recorded missing words through definition, function, contrast, or example. I-SPEAK-KEY	The speaker completes the idea without abandoning it and uses the substitute accurately. I-SPEAK
Limited complex-form control prevents the next GRA band	Rebuild two recorded answers using one needed relationship such as cause, condition, contrast, or qualification, then answer a new question spontaneously. I-SPEAK-KEY	The new answer uses varied structures accurately enough to preserve meaning without sounding memorised. I-SPEAK
Listener effort prevents the next Pronunciation band	Locate the smallest responsible feature: chunk boundary, prominence, rhythm, word stress, connected speech, or phoneme contrast. I-SPEAK-KEY	A fresh listener identifies the intended message with less effort in a new response containing the same feature. R-FEEDBACK

6. Student higher-band record

Complete one record after one full practice task. Keep one blocking feature, one practice action, and one measurable recheck; feedback that cannot be translated into a response may produce little improvement.

[R-FEEDBACK](#)

Question	Student entry
What test, skill, task, date, and conditions produced the result?	_____ T-STAND
What current raw score, criterion band, or confirmed pattern am I using?	_____ I-SCORE
What exact response evidence supports that result?	_____ R-FEEDBACK
What next score or descriptor feature am I targeting?	_____ I-WRITE I-SPEAK
What exact answer failure or unsupported feature blocks it?	_____ R-READ
What single practice action will target that feature?	_____ R-FEEDBACK
What must a comparable new response show?	_____ R-RUBRIC
Recheck task, date, conditions, and result	_____ T-STAND

7. Teacher diagnostic records

Record enough evidence to justify the current result, identify the first unsupported next-band feature, prescribe its matching action, and evaluate a comparable recheck. [I-WRITE](#) [R-FEEDBACK](#)

7.1 Assessment identity

Field	Entry
Student/sample ID; teacher; date; attempt	_____ T-STAND
Academic/GT; skill; task; form or prompt ID	_____ T-STAND
Mode; timing; independent/draft/revised; access arrangement	_____ I-ACCESS
Complete/partial/unusable evidence; official/practice/classroom/IE /NR status	_____ T-STAND

7.2 Listening/Reading item record

Item(s)	Type	Correct/total	Exact failure	Confirmed pattern or hypothesis	Action and success check
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____ R-READ
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____ R-READ
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____ R-READ
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____ R-READ
Summary		Entry			
Raw correct /40; exact-form conversion source		_____ I-SCORE			
Strongest supported pattern		_____ R-READ			
Priority pattern and confirmation task		_____ R-READ			
Recheck form/date/result		_____ T-STAND			

7.3 Writing profile

Criterion	Band/ IE/NR	Representative evidence	Higher band checked	Limiting feature
Task Achievement or Task Response	_____	_____	_____	_____ I-WRITE
Coherence and Cohesion	_____	_____	_____	_____ I-WRITE
Lexical Resource	_____	_____	_____	_____ I-WRITE
Grammatical Range and Accuracy	_____	_____	_____	_____ I-WRITE

Writing check	Entry
Task/prompt ID; Academic/GT; Task 1/2; exact word count	_____ I-WRITE-A I-WRITE-G
Task coverage: overview/key features or purpose/bullets, or Task 2 prompt parts/position/support	_____ I-WRITE-KEY
Copied, formulaic, unrelated, or missing evidence	_____ I-WRITE
Strongest criterion; priority criterion; action; success check	_____ R-FEEDBACK
Comparable recheck prompt/date/profile	_____ T-STAND

7.4 Speaking profile

Criterion	Band/ IE/NR	Evidence across Parts 1- 3	Higher band checked	Limiting feature
Fluency and Coherence	_____	_____	_____	_____ I-SPEAK
Lexical Resource	_____	_____	_____	_____ I-SPEAK
Grammatical Range and Accuracy	_____	_____	_____	_____ I-SPEAK
Pronunciation	_____	_____	_____	_____ I-SPEAK

Speaking check	Entry
Part completion; delivery mode; rating mode; recording quality	_____ I-SPEAK-FMT R-MODE
Pauses/repair; paraphrase; range/accuracy; intelligibility/listener effort	_____ I-SPEAK-KEY
Strongest criterion; priority criterion; action; success check	_____ R-FEEDBACK
Comparable recheck date/profile	_____ T-STAND

8. Teacher reliability appendix

8.1 Rating gates

Evidence condition	Rating treatment	Preparation consequence
Complete Writing response	Rate all four criteria independently against the correct task descriptors. I-WRITE	Target the first unsupported clause in each criterion rather than one overall weakness. I-WRITE-KEY
No Writing attempt, non-English throughout, or proven wholly memorised response	Apply the official Band 0 task condition. I-WRITE	Obtain an independent English response before assigning a language-development target. T-STAND
Writing response of 20 words or fewer or wholly unrelated content	Apply the official Band 1 task condition; copied task wording supplies no evidence. I-WRITE	Establish a relevant, independent, connected response before targeting higher-band features. I-WRITE
Writing below 150 or 250 words	Record the exact count; public sources supply no universal flat numerical deduction. I-WRITE-A I-WRITE-G	Diagnose the missing task coverage and language evidence rather than teaching a fabricated penalty. I-WRITE
Formulaic or rehearsed Writing language	Judge relevance, integration, adaptability, and independently produced language. I-WRITE	Replace unusable template language with task-specific content and fresh evidence. R-FEEDBACK
Complete Speaking interview	Rate all four criteria from average performance across Parts 1-3. I-SPEAK	Target the criterion feature that repeatedly limits the complete interview. I-SPEAK-KEY
Missing part or unusable recording	Record the missing evidence and use IE when no fair whole-interview rating is supportable. T-STAND	Obtain a complete comparable interview before prescribing a band transition. T-STAND
Hesitation, self-correction, accent, opinion, confidence, or eye contact	Score only the observable effect represented in the four published criteria. I-SPEAK-KEY	Practise the scored language or intelligibility feature and avoid irrelevant coaching targets. I-SPEAK
Audio-only classroom sample	Label it mode-limited because removing visual information can affect ratings. R-MODE	Use it formatively and confirm consequential decisions with a complete interview. T-STAND

8.2 Second marking and calibration

1. Obtain another rating when evidence is incomplete, the decision is consequential, one isolated feature controls the judgment, or independent raters exceed the programme's review rule. [T-STAND](#)
2. Keep ratings independent, compare one criterion at a time, and identify the exact evidence interpreted differently. [R-CC](#)
3. Resolve the decision from the complete sample and current descriptor; use a third review or new sample when evidence remains insufficient. [I-WRITE](#) [I-SPEAK](#)
4. Calibrate with current descriptors and scored examples, rating independently before discussion and recording the evidence behind any difference. [I-WRITE-SAMPLE-A](#) [T-STAND](#)

8.3 Access and evidence fairness

Rule	Application
Approved arrangements	Record the actual accessible materials, time, breaks, technology, reader, scribe, or other approved support used. I-ACCESS
Scored evidence	Apply the published criteria unless official instructions state otherwise; score keyed answers and produced language rather than effort, personality, reputation, handwriting style, accent identity, or assumed potential. I-ACCESS T-STAND
Evidence limit	Record how access, technology, conditions, or incompleteness changed the available evidence and obtain a comparable sample instead of guessing. T-STAND

8.4 Result boundaries

Result	Report	Exclude
Official IELTS	The score copied from one authorised result document. I-SCORE	Locally recombined or best-of-sittings results. T-STAND
Listening or Reading practice	Raw /40 plus the named exact-form conversion, or raw /40 alone. I-SCORE	A universal permanent conversion or invented qualitative descriptor. I-SCORE
Writing or Speaking classroom profile	Criterion bands, representative evidence, conditions, and IE/NR where needed. I-WRITE I-SPEAK	Official status, invented half-band descriptors, or unsupported precision. T-STAND
Diagnostic note	The repeated pattern, confirmation task, preparation action, and recheck. R-READ	Cognitive, motivational, learning, or medical diagnoses inferred from errors. T-STAND

8.5 Unsupported shortcuts

These fixed thresholds do not appear in the cited descriptors or research and must not determine a band or preparation plan. [I-WRITE](#) [I-SPEAK](#)

- A fixed number of grammar, spelling, or vocabulary errors. [R-ERROR](#)
- A required number of complex sentences, connectors, paragraphs, uncommon words, idioms, or examples. [R-WRITE](#)
- A words-per-minute target, pause count, memorised template, particular accent, or isolated pronunciation feature. [R-SPEAK](#)
- One immutable Listening or Reading conversion for every test form. [I-SCORE](#)
- An audio-only monologue treated as equivalent to the interactive three-part Speaking test. [R-MODE](#)
- A single practice result treated as proof of stable improvement. [T-STAND](#)

9. Sources

Every scoring statement links to its governing source. Each entry below also prints its complete URL, so it remains copyable if a PDF viewer blocks clicking. Official IELTS sources define test rules and bands; research supports classroom interpretation and does not create IELTS rules. Sources were checked 6 September 2026. [T-STAND](#)

9.1 Official IELTS

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11. **I-WRITE-SAMPLE-G.** IELTS. *General Training Writing Sample Tasks 2023*. <https://ielts.org/cdn/Sample-tests/ielts-general-training-writing-sample-tasks-2023.pdf>. Task instructions and sample materials.
12. **I-SPEAK-FMT.** IELTS. *Speaking test format*. <https://ielts.org/take-a-test/test-types/ielts-academic-test/ielts-academic-format-speaking>. Three-part interview structure and timing.
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14. **I-SPEAK-KEY.** IELTS. *Speaking Key Assessment Criteria*. <https://ielts.org/cdn/ielts-guides/ielts-speaking-key-assessment-criteria.pdf>. Feature-level explanations of the four criteria.
15. **I-GUIDE.** IELTS. *Guide for Test Takers 2026*. <https://ielts.org/cdn/ielts-downloadable-assets/ielts-guidance-and-support/ielts-guides/ielts-guide-for-test-takers.pdf>. Current four-skill structure and suggested Writing time allocation.
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9.2 Assessment standards and research

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